Best Practices for Biomedical Research Data Management

Module 5: Data Management Policy Institutional Policies

Rebecca Reznik-Zellen, MLIS, UMass Medical School

This video will describe the objectives of and elements generally addressed in institutional policies regarding data management. It will talk about why institutions need data policies in place, and who the major stakeholders involved are.

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Institutional Policies

"[I]nstitutions … are now realizing, if they didn't already, that they need to plan for research data management infrastructure on the ground across the entire research data lifecycle.

JISC. 2012. Managing Research Data blog "Gathering Evidence" Developing Research Data Management Policy. Available from: https://mrdevidence.jiscinvolve.org/wp/2012/02/17/developing-research-data-management-policy/

Objectives

- Articulate roles and responsibilities for data management
- Set expectations for data management
- Account for mobility of researchers
- Accommodate longitudinal studies
- Provide support for researchers without external funding

Institutional policy & procedures	IT infrastructure (hardware & software)	Support services (people & advice)	Managing metadata
Appropriate policies* & procedures* in place to cover:	Adequate IT infrastructure* in place to support:	Staff and capabilities to support:	Activities to support:
• Research data management • Research data ownership & storage • Access to databases & archives • Retention of materials & research data following a research project • Collaborative research projects with other research organisations • Ethics, Codes, Funding Requirements and relevant Legislative Frameworks • Data sharing & re-use • Secure & safe disposal of research data • Intellectual property, copyright & patents • Records management	• Storage of data & metadata, for both collaboration & archiving • Identity management, authentication, & access • Internal & external network connectivity • Access to discipline specific tools to support analysis • Software development • Visualisation • Collaborative Environments • High Performance Computing	• Training of researchers & support staff • Data management planning, including relevant standards • Discovery and access • Data security mechanisms • Data sharing & re-use • Data curation • Appraisal of collections, & assistance with preservation & sustainability • Awareness, outreach and marketing	• Identification of datasets • Implementation of relevant metadata standards • Creation of metadata records for discipline requirements • Creation of metadata records for preservation requirements • Creation of metadata records for Research Data Australia — Collections, Parties, Activities, Services • Sharing of metadata with Research Data Australia and other portals • Administrative metadata to support recording of ownership, retention period, access rules, etc • Statistical information on publication and use
Policies and procedures to be: • Up to date • Addressing data-related issues • Widely publicised • Include compliance measures			
* separate policies for all of these may not be required	* not all institutions will require all of these		

Australian National Data Service. Creating a data management framework. Available from: http://www.ands.org.au/guides/creating-a-data-management-framework

Institutional Policies

Elements

- Scope
- Ownership
- Retention/Disposition
- Ethical Considerations (IRB and sensitive data)
- Access
- Sharing
- Responsibilities

Stakeholders

- University
- Office of Research
- Research Compliance
- Information Technology
- Academic Units
- Researchers
- The Library

Erway R. 2013. Starting the Conversation: University-wide Research Data Management Policy. OCLC. Available from: http://www.oclc.org/content/dam/research/publications/library/2013/2013-08.pdf

Institutional Policies

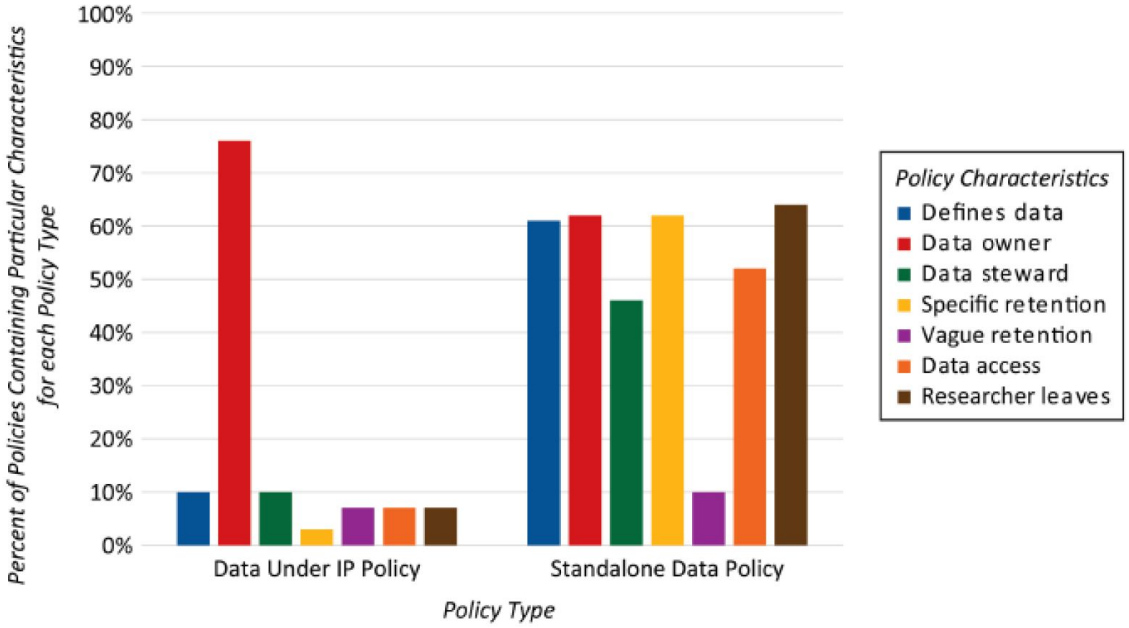

Figure 5. Policy Contents for Standalone Policies and IP Policies Covering Research Data

Briney K., Goben A., and Zilinsky, L. (2015) Do You Have An Institutional Data Policy? A Review of the Current Landscape of Library Data Services and Institutional Data Policies. Journal of Librarianship and Scholarly Communication 3(2). doi: 10.7710/2162-3309.1232